Your free community magazine about Thamesmead

thamesview

www.gallionsha.co.uk

April 06

Inside this issue



Marathon Facts

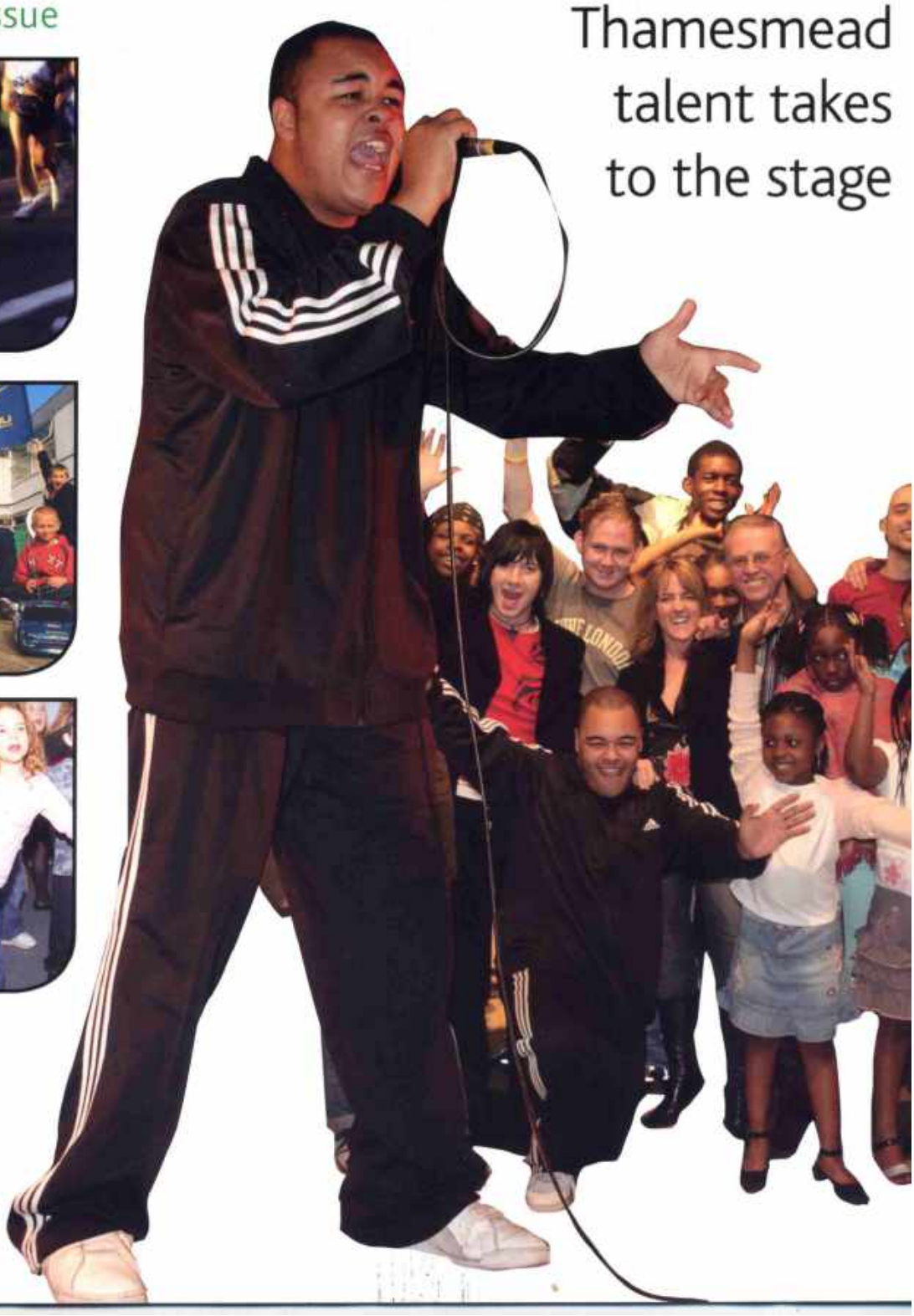


Community Wardens



Disco Divas

Thamesmead talent takes to the stage



GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

Editorial

With the summer fast approaching, Gallions Neighbourhood Wardens are putting together a programme of events for Thamesmead's young people. The Wardens will be touring around the parks and open spaces offering a range of sports and outdoor activities. Just some of the things they are looking at include professional cricket coaching, football tournaments and the hugely popular computer car club. They are also looking into the possibility of running cycling classes for children. All in all it is shaping up to be a real summer of fun.

Complaints Contacts

Gallions aims to provide a first class service to all its residents. However, if you are unhappy with the service you have received there is a policy in place to help you make a complaint. A step-by-step guide is available on the Gallions website under the 'contact us' section. You may also get in touch with the Complaints Management team who will advise you what action to take. Your feedback is important to Gallions.

complaints@gallionsha.co.uk
www.gallionsha.co.uk
0800 83 84 81

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Tenants Resource Centre

There are always a wide range of courses and groups being held at Gallions Tenants Resource Centre, Harrow Manor Way. If you are interested in finding out more about what's going on and what's available then please call Linda Woods on 0208 320 3468.

Customer Contacts Number

Gallions call centre is sometimes closed during office hours for staff training. To ensure your service continues as normal, all calls are automatically forwarded to Amicus, Gallions emergency repair service.



Thamesview Contacts

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ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਬਾਕਸ ਅਾਪਣੇ ਚਿੰਨ੍ਹ ਲਾਓ ਜੀ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਦਿਓ ਤਾਕਿ ਤੁਹਾਨੂੰ ਲਿਖਤ ਵਿਚ ਜਾਣਕਾਰੀ ਮਿਲ ਸਕੇ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾，請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu nầy, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

Punjabi ○ Chinese ○ Vietnamese ○
(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

Return to: Joy McKee, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

Missed a rent payment?

Have you received a letter from Gallions advising you that you are in rent arrears, but you are sure that you have paid? It is possible that your payment is being held in Gallions suspense account. If funds are received without all the correct details such as tenancy numbers or other identifying information, Gallions may not be able to credit them to the correct rental account. Alma Kent, Gallions Credit Control Team Leader says:

"We investigate cases like these as far as possible and are often able to identify and credit payments even if key information is missing. In some cases, however we cannot identify whose payment has been received."

If this situation could apply to you then please get in touch with Gallions Credit Control Team.

In order to help Gallions track down your payment, you will need to produce copies of relevant receipts or have details of your standing order available.

Please do keep your receipts for all payments until you have checked them against your quarterly rent statements. This makes it easier to track down missing payments.

Call your Credit Control officer on 0800 838481 to discuss missed or missing rental payments.

neighbourhood forums

Gallions neighbourhood forums take place every quarter. They are an opportunity for residents to come along and hear what is going on in and around their local neighbourhood. Gallions staff and members of Gallions Residents Board will be on hand to discuss any issues or concerns you may have. You will learn about what community projects are in the pipeline and what steps are being taken to address any local problems. Just come along and have your say.

Lesnes, Parkview & Greenmead
The Atrium, Teeswater Court
From 7pm until 9pm
Wednesday 12th April

Manorway & Crossway
Manor Close Hall
From 7pm until 9pm
Tuesday 18th April

Waterfield
St Pauls Church
From 7pm until 9pm
Wednesday 19th April

Broadwaters
The Village Hall
From 7pm until 9pm
Monday 24th April

Southmere
Tavy Bridge Hall
From 7pm until 9pm
Tuesday 2nd May

Moorings
Arnott Club Room
From 7pm until 9pm
Thursday 4th May

Cutting costs at home

With the recent hike in fuel prices, the average UK household energy bill is now set to break through the £1,000 a year barrier for the first time. Here are some top tips to help you save money and tackle increasing fuel bills.

Ideally your thermostat should not be higher than 60°C/140°F. Simply by turning it down by 1°C you could take 10 % off your bill. Do make sure that you keep the heat in your home. Just closing the curtains in the evenings will help cut costs.

You will be surprised at the difference some small changes to your everyday habits can make to your energy bills. Turning off the lights when you leave a room, taking appliances off 'standby' mode and only boiling as much water as you need, will help reduce the amount of money you spend.

Did you know that a dripping hot water tap wastes enough hot water in a week to fill half a bath! Fix dripping taps and replace light bulbs with energy saving recommended ones. They can reduce your lighting costs by up to £78 over the lifetime of the bulb.

Turn to page 11 for details of how you can get four low energy light bulbs absolutely free.

Keeping up appearances

As part of the association's commitment to delivering the government's Decent Homes agenda, Gallions has signed up to a 14- year partnership agreement with Axis Europe Plc. Residents whose homes fall into the 2006/2007 programme for improvements and refurbishments will shortly be receiving details of what's happening and when.

For more information about how the planned maintenance programme may affect you, please call Gallions Customer Contact Centre on 0800 83 84 81.

T Factor talent is top of the pops



Saturday 4th March was the day Thamesmead's best and brightest stars took to the stage at Woolwich Polytechnic and really shone. At a talent show organised by Trust Thamesmead, some 75 acts sang, danced and recited in front of a judging panel that included ITV's X factor star Tabby. All were competing for the prize of a 15-minute slot supporting the headline act on the main stage at Trust Thamesmead's Summer Festival on 15 July.

After a day of performances packed with energy and enthusiasm Byron Parara was finally announced the winner. While rap singer Byron took the top slot four other fantastic acts, all from Thamesmead, were considered to be worthy of time on the main stage too. Five-piece band The Illusions, dance group Myztikal and solo singer Danielle Staras will each have 10 minute slots with a judges' special award of a main stage spot going to young girl singers Abisola and Kansola Ogunledun and Morayo Omoniyi.

The chair of Trust Thamesmead's board of trustees Jackie Smith was overwhelmed by the level of talent and professionalism on display.

She said *"This may be the first time we have organised an event of this kind but it certainly won't be the last. We want to do this every year from now on."*

Gallions resident is BBC Winner

Gallions resident Shelley Guilfoyle couldn't believe it when she received a call from the BBC saying she had won the trip of a lifetime. Earlier this year twenty five year old Shelley had answered an advertisement in the Sun newspaper. After months of interviews and video recordings, Shelley finally learned that she had been selected to join a team trekking in the Peruvian jungle with Ben Fogle.

As part of a BBC programme called Extreme Dreams, the winners will be filmed spending10 days in the jungle. Shelley is over the moon to be going. She says. ***"Just to take part in something like this, to go to another country and to see a different culture and way of life is an amazing opportunity."***

To get ready for the physical challenges that lie ahead, Shelley has been stepping up her exercise routine with more trips to the gym and swimming pool. ***"Whatever happens, I am going to make the absolute most of this chance."***

Shelley's jungle adventure started in March and readers will be able to see for themselves just how she got on when the programme is aired in September.

YOUR TAKE ON THAMESMEAD

Tavy Bridge resident Sue Bellinger has lived in Thamesmead all her life and here she tells us about her hopes and dreams for her neighbourhood.

What is your greatest fear?

That Thamesmead could lose it community feel. It sometimes feels as if we have a lot of people who only stay here for a short time and not make it their home for the future.

What is your greatest dream?

That we can thrive on the regeneration of Tavy Bridge, and build up the community spirit that was here when I was growing up. I would like my son to experience the kind of childhood that I had in Thamesmead.

What would you like to see achieved in ten years time?

That the regeneration of Tavy Bridge brings in local jobs for local people, to help keep the area financially strong. And that Thamesmead becomes one area without the problems we have now with two boroughs.

How do you think this can be achieved?

With residents and Gallions Housing Association working together. We need more resident involvement in the running of our homes and area and everyone should look forward to living in Thamesmead and being a part of the community.

The long legs of the law!

Gallions Housing Association was one of the sponsors backing an 18-strong marathon team from Bexleyheath Police station. Running to raise funds for Cancer Resarch UK and the Greenwich and Bexley Cottage Hospice, many of the team have never run competitively before. Inspector Steve Duffy was responsible for bringing the team together. He says: ***"The marathon was a great opportunity for us to give something back to the community."***



Debbie Cheeseman of Cancer Research UK and Howard King from the Cottage Hospice receiving the cheque.

Thames 21 turns the tide against litter

Thames 21 is an organisation committed to clearing up London's rivers and canals. Their work takes them all over the capital and now they have turned their attention to Thamesmead's network of waterways. Working in partnership with Team Gallions, Thames 21 is looking for v olunteers to join them on their next major clear up on 15th April. Starting at 11am on the canal at the Moorings at Bentham Road, local residents and community groups are invited to join in. This is the second canal clean up in Thamesmead and many more are planned throughout the year. Team Gallions manager Tom Broad says 'The waterways are places where local people can fish or canoe or simply as a place to relax and unwind. This much needed clean up work will benefit local people as well as helping to protect important wildlife habitats.'

More information about Thames 21's work can be found at www.thames21.org.uk.

If you are interested in joining in the clean up, please contact the river co-ordinator at ashe.hurst@thames21.org.



have your say

Gallions Service Improvement team are always looking for ways to make sure residents are receiving a good quality service that meets their needs. If you have any thoughts or comments on Gallions service please contact Sue Pollard on 0208 320 3425.

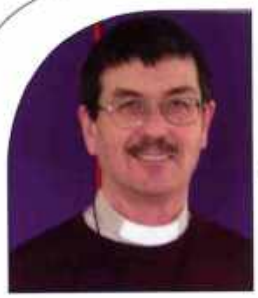
drop us a line

Such has been the success of *Gallions fishing club* that they have now joined forces with *Thames 21* and the *Thamesmead Angling Club* as more and more people sign up for this popular activity.

The club starts on 26th April and is open to every over 8 years old.

For more information please call Wendy Mason on 0208 320 3417.

ONE2ONE



From Brazil to Broadwaters

Twenty-two years ago the Reverend Simon Boxall and his wife Rachel arrived in Brazil as members of the South America Mission Society. Today, back on British shores, they are the driving force behind a new, multi-denominational church in West Thamesmead. Here Simon tells Thamesview what brought him back to England and about his plans for the future.

When Simon saw an advertisement for a minister to set up a pioneering new church in Thamesmead he didn't hesitate in applying for the job. Two years later he and his family are firmly established in the Vicarage in Battery Road. Simon is part of a four strong team of multi-denominational clergymen who are working towards bringing people of all church backgrounds and those with no church experience at all together to worship as one. The team's goal is to reach out to everyone regardless of religion and background. Simon says:

'While I was very excited about my new job, I was also terrified. This was a whole new area of work and there was no format to follow. It was an entirely blank canvas for me to paint as I liked.'

Since forming the Open Gateway United Church, Simon has found nothing but support and kindness from the people of Thamesmead. His church has quickly become a meeting point for a wide range of people of all ages and backgrounds. While some drop in for the regular Friday coffee mornings, others attend the arts and craft classes run by Rachel. However, Simon believes that a real sense of community is lacking in this part of Thamesmead. He hopes that his church will go a small way in helping to address this problem.

'Often people see Thamesmead as a stepping stone to somewhere else. People come and go quickly with no real roots being set down. I feel strongly that many people in this area are suffering from isolation and loneliness.'

By initially running small, local events such as garden barbecues and Easter egg hunts, Simon hopes that he can start to develop a greater sense of belonging for the residents of Thamesmead. To build a community there needs to be a focal point that encourages people to come together. The Open Gateway United Church could provide that focal point.'

Simon's Sunday evening services are a mix of traditional and modern aspects of the church. Visitors can enjoy Powerpoint presentations and Bible readings as well as singing and discussion groups. This informal, relaxed atmosphere appeals to people from all walks of life and religious backgrounds. Together Simon and Rachel are committed to making the Open Gateway United Church as accessible and welcoming to as many people as possible. And, if the steady stream of visitors and phone calls are anything to go by, it seems as if they are well on their way to achieving their goal.

Contact: Reverend Simon Boxall
The Open Gateway United Church 62 –64 Battery Road
Thamesmead SE28 OJT

easter bonnet parade

Finally, the sun is shining, flowers are in bloom and Easter is just around the corner. After what seems like a very long winter, we are all now enjoying the sights and sounds of spring. This year, Gallions Broadwaters patch team has organised an Easter Bonnet Parade for elderly residents in the Broadwaters area. It is a great chance to get creative with ribbons, flowers, baubles and hats. Whether you make your own bonnet or simply turn up to model the hats on show, why not come along and enjoy an afternoon of good company, good fun and the chance to win a discounted meal at the Princess Alice.

The Easter Bonnet Parade will take place from 1pm to 3pm on Thursday 13th April 2006 at the Village Hall. Afternoon tea will be served. For more information, please call Wendy Mason on 0800 83 84 81.



April is the month that sees runners of all shapes, sizes and ages pounding London's pavements to raise money for their favourite charities. The London Marathon attracts people from all over the world and every year it gives us amazing stories of strength, courage and just a little madness. We take a look back at how it all started.



1. The first London Marathon was run on 29th March 1981.



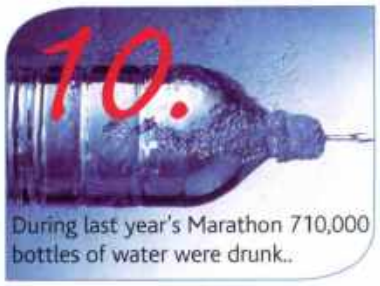
5. The London Marathon also includes a wheelchair race that has famously been won by Dame Tanni Grey-Thompson 6 times.

9. In 2005 a record 35,105 runners crossed the finishing line.

2. Since 1981 it is estimated that over £200 million has been raised for charities.



6. This year's marathon will take place on 23rd April 2006.



10. During last year's Marathon 710,000 bottles of water were drunk..



3. The London Marathon is the single biggest annual fundraising event nationwide.

7. The Marathon starts in Greenwich Park and runs all the way to The Mall in front of Buckingham Palace.

11. The current holder of the fastest Marathon time is Khalid Khannouchi, with a time of 2 hours, 5 minutes and 38 seconds in 2002.

4. The first Mini Marathon was run in 1986. It is run over the last 2.65 miles of the Marathon course and is for children aged 11 – 17.



8. The London Marathon is 26.2 miles long – that's roughly 42 thousand steps.

12. Raising money for Leukaemia, Lloyd Scott set the slowest time by walking the Marathon in a deep-sea diving suit. It took him 5 days, 8 hours and 29 minutes from start to finish.

WHAT'S ON AT TAVY BRIDGE

At the Tavy Bridge Project Office there are many FREE advice centres and groups that are there to help you. Along with information about the progress of the area's regeneration, there are a number of other meetings and sessions that may be of interest to you.

Welfare Benefits Advice

Gallions specialist advisor Derek Stainsby is on hand to make sure residents are receiving their full entitlement to housing benefits, social security benefits and tax credits.

He runs a session from the project office every 2nd Wednesday of each month from 10am until 4pm.

Neighbourhood Advice Sessions

Gallions Neighbourhood Warden's and Housing Co-Ordinators are available at the project office every Thursday afternoon from 3:30pm to 5pm to discuss any problems or concerns you have.

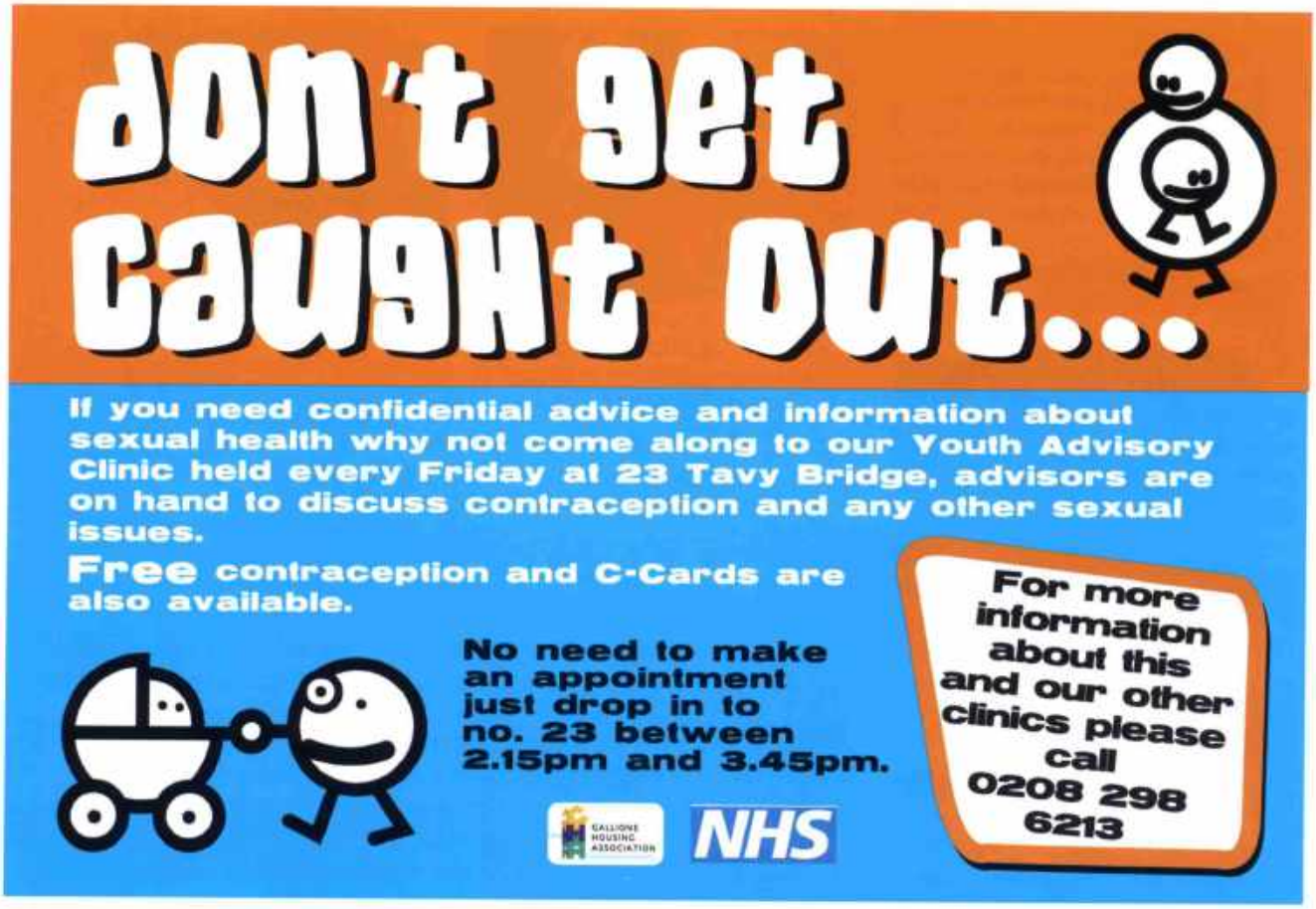
Employment Service

Trust Thamesmead's Building Futures project now runs a session every Tuesday from 10.00am to 12.30pm help you seek employment.

Legal Advice

Law Centre volunteers and trained welfare rights advisors will be available to discuss any queries you have or to give advice every Tuesday from 1.30pm to 3.30pm

There is no need to book to attend these meetings - just come along to the project office on the days and times that suit you.



meet the team

A credit to us

This month Thamesview takes a look at Gallions Credit Control Team. While each member of the team has a specific role to play together they are there to oversee all aspects of Gallions rental collection process. The team also provides help, advice and support on such areas as debt management and welfare benefits.



Violet Amédée

Credit Control Manager

(Pictured)

vamedee@gallionsha.co.uk

Background

Violet has spent most of her career working in the social housing sector in a variety of housing management roles. Her responsibilities have included managing the provision and delivery of neighbourhood services.

Role in The Association

Since joining Gallions in 2003, Violet has been responsible for improving the association's income levels. Working closely with her team and other colleagues, Violet makes sure that Gallions collects any income owed from both residential and non- residential tenants. This income goes towards providing some of the money the Association needs to deliver existing and new services to its residents.

"Many of our staff have come from outside the social housing sector giving us a very mixed team with a range of skills and personalities that work well together.
Everyone supports each other in working towards reducing arrears, providing help and cover when needed."

Alma Kent

Credit Control Team Leader

akent@gallionsha.co.uk

Background

Alma has worked in housing for 19 years joining Thamesmead Town in October 1992 as a Housing Assistant. In 2000, when Thamesmead Town converted to Gallions she moved to Credit Control where she took charge of the management of rent accounts and the collection of rent arrears.

Role in The Association

Today Alma's role is to support and advise the team as they collect housing debts owed to the association. Working with Credit Control and Court Enforcement Officers, as well as liaising with other departments, Alma has put in place a number of processes to ensure the team carries out its duties as effectively as possible.

June Field

Court Enforcement Officer

jfield@gallionsha.co.uk

Background

June joined Thamesmead Town in July 1994 as a Clerical Assistant. Since then she has progressed through the ranks starting as a Housing Assistant and moving on to specialise in the collection of rent arrears.

Role in The Association

June's role is to monitor rent arrears. Where necessary, June will issue possession proceedings and obtain court orders in the County Court. Sometimes it is necessary to attend evictions and to execute warrants of possession in conjunction with the County Court Bailiffs.

Derek Stainsby

Welfare Benefits Officer

stainsby@gallionsha.co.uk

Background

Derek has been welfare benefits officer at Gallions since February 2002. He has many years welfare rights experience as a volunteer, and worked for several local authorities before returning to full time professional welfare rights work with Gallions. More and more, Derek is now called upon to help other advisors working in welfare benefits.

Role in The Association

Derek spends his time making sure residents are receiving their full entitlement to housing benefit, social security benefits and tax credits. His role has grown and now includes representing residents at Tribunals and before the Social Security Commissioners.

Credit Control Officers

Michael Hemp, Sophie Round & Michael Day

mhemp@gallionsha.co.uk
sround@gallionsha.co.uk
mday@gallionsha.co.uk

DEALING WITH DEBT

Is debt becoming a problem for you?

Are you having trouble meeting your financial commitments? Then why not get in touch with Gallions Debt Helpline. Specialist advisers will be in touch to discuss your options.

DEBT HELPLINE
0208 320 3687

DEAL WITH DEBT, DON'T IGNORE IT.

Young People

Cave Climbing Wall
Thamesmead's climbing wall is an excellent way to learn a new skill or to improve on your climbing technique. **www.trust-thamesmeadcave.co.uk**
Tel: 0208 320 4494

Fun Club
Glimpsing Green
Saturday morning fun for children up to 11 who have a disability or a special need.
Tel: 020 8311 6777

Brownies
Church of the Cross,
Lensbury Way
Girls aged 7 to 11
Tel: 0208 310 2419

Guides
Church of the Cross,
Lensbury Way
Girls aged 11+
Tel: 0208 310 2419

Greenmeade Community Hall
- *Carer & Child Drop-in*
- *Sunshine Club for children with autism*

Tel: 0208 303 1006

Rainbows
Arnott Close Club Room
girls aged 5 to 11 years

Brownies
Arnott Close Club Room
girls aged 7 to 11 years
Tel: 0208 244 3488
07958 967902
e. sandy.white70@ntlworld.com

New Acres Library Tavy Bridge
Tel: 020 8311 5291

- *Baby Time*
  Nursery rhymes, singing, stories for the under 4's and their parents.
- *Family Learning*
  For children 5 + years and their parents.
- *Story Time*
  For children 3 to 5 years and their parents.
- *Teenage Reading Group*
  Fun activities to help teenagers discover books.

Music and Dance

Myztikal
Church of the Cross Hall
Lensbury Way
Street dance classes
ages 8 to 15
Tel: 07956 949249

Theatre Street
Broadwater Village Hall
Gooseander Way
Dancing, singing and drama
Tel: 01322 441977
Web: www.theatrestreet.com

Youth Advisory Project
Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
Music for 16 to 24 years old
Tel: 020 8311 5111

Clubs and Groups for the Elderly

Over 50's Bingo Club
Greenmeade Community Hall
Monday and Thursday
7.30 to 9pm
Tel: 0208 303 1006

Pop-In Parlour
Evenlode House
Coralline Walk
Tel: 020 8310 7437

Teeswater Atrium
Variety of groups and activities 7 days a week Including Bingo, darts, sewing, ballroom and line dancing and an African social group.
Tel: 0800 83 084 81

After School Clubs

Birchmere Club
Near ***Disraeli Close***
Tel: 020 8311 8886

Hawksmoor Youth Club
Bentham Road
Tel: 020 8312 4022

Heronsgate Club
Whinchat Road
Tel: 07950612826

Playgroups

Goose-e-ganders
Parent and Toddler group.
Tel: 07958 640645

Toddles
Manor Close Community Hall
Manor Close
Tel: 020 8310 9004

Toddles with Tavy Bridge Pre-School
Senior Citizens Hall,
Tavy Bridge
Tel: 07950 853481

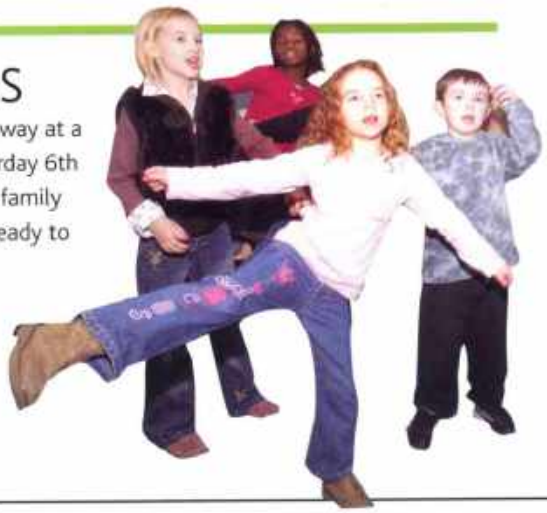
To list your group please contact Joy Mckee on 0208 320 3414

DISCO DADS AND DANCING DIVAS

Mums, dads, grandparents and children are all invited to dance the night away at a fund raising disco in Abbey Wood's Community Hall in the Village on Saturday 6th May. Organised by Waterways Nursery, Thamesmead, it is sure be a great family evening out. So dig out your disco gear, brush up on your moves and get ready to boogie on down. The fun starts at 7pm with the last dance at 11pm.

Tickets cost £5 for adults and £2 for children under 14.

To book your ticket, please telephone Waterways Nursery on 0208 311 5491.



WISE-UP™ TO ENERGY SAVING

POWERGEN

Get 4 free

new size low energy light bulbs today

Switching your traditional bulbs to low energy ones means that you can save energy and money and do your bit for the environment.*

Compared to ordinary light bulbs, our low energy light bulbs are:

- just as bright but use up to 80% less electricity
- longlife – lasting around 6 times longer
- easy to install as they have bayonet fittings



To receive 2 FREE 11W (60W) and 2 FREE 8W (40W) low energy light bulbs, you need to be in receipt of one of the following qualifying benefits or credits:

- Council Tax Benefit
- Housing Benefit
- Income Support
- Income-based Job Seeker's Allowance
- Attendance Allowance
- Disabilty Living Allowance
- Disablement Pension which includes constant attendance allowance
- War Disablement Pension which includes either a mobility supplement or constant attendance allowance
- State Pension Credit
- Child Tax Credit where the relevant income is £14,600 or less
- Working Tax Credit where the relevant income is £14,600 or less

* This pack could save you over £74 based on replacing two 60W and two 40W traditional light bulbs used for an average of five hours per day and an electricity cost of £7.81p/kWh (including VAT).

If the coupon below is missing, please send your name, address and benefit details quoting ref: LELB2 to: Powergen, FREEPOST, PO Box 7, Manchester, M19 2HD.

Positive Energy

How to claim your 4 FREE low energy light bulbs

Simply fill in your details opposite, detach the coupon, place it in an envelope (no stamp required) and send it to:

Powergen
FREEPOST
PO Box 7
Manchester
M19 2HD

Ref: LELB2

COUPON

Name

Address

Postcode

Please state benefit received (see above)

Signature

All benefit status details supplied on this coupon are solely for compliance with Ofgem regulations and will be treated in strict confidence.

Are you happy to receive further information about products and services of Powergen and its associated companies?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Terms & Conditions. Customers need to be in receipt of one of the qualifying benefits or credits listed to qualify for the FREE light bulbs. Please allow 28 days for delivery. Only one pack of FREE bulbs per household. Offer available to residents of Great Britain only. This offer is available between 1 April 2005 and 31 March 2008. Powergen reserves the right to change or withdraw this offer at any time.

A QUESTION OF SPORT

Now's your chance to become top of the leader board. If you take pole position in this month's word search then you could be top place on the podium and collect £25 worth of WHSmith vouchers.

- FOOTBALL
- BASKETBALL
- BADMINTON
- RUGBY
- GOLF
- TENNIS
- NETBALL
- SQUASH
- HOCKEY
- CRICKET
- BASEBALL
- RUNNING

H	S	E	G	S	S	L	B	R	S	L	B	K	F	T	I	N	G	R	A	G
B	A	S	E	B	A	L	L	A	L	N	C	B	D	A	T	M	E	C	B	N
M	E	T	N	B	L	F	I	A	B	S	N	I	U	E	E	C	A	B	A	R
A	B	I	U	B	B	S	B	A	G	B	U	G	Y	L	K	B	C	B	G	N
O	F	L	O	G	L	T	U	S	A	R	U	G	B	Y	C	L	F	B	K	A
A	D	A	U	K	E	A	S	D	Q	O	Q	U	D	B	I	O	T	L	R	R
L	R	A	G	K	C	L	M	I	N	U	A	S	K	I	R	S	A	R	U	B
L	T	O	S	B	E	I	T	B	N	S	A	A	N	L	O	R	F	S	N	R
L	M	A	E	A	N	E	M	A	U	N	N	S	Q	L	L	B	R	E	N	C
E	B	R	O	T	L	U	L	L	A	N	E	H	H	A	K	B	A	B	I	T
A	B	E	O	K	L	B	I	I	N	U	K	T	A	B	E	O	I	T	N	B
K	Q	N	L	F	O	O	T	B	A	L	L	I	Y	T	R	G	E	A	G	N
B	Y	L	L	C	A	O	E	I	T	K	R	B	O	E	S	L	A	L	C	I
Q	L	B	I	S	R	L	O	E	Y	O	N	F	T	N	O	T	L	N	A	N
L	R	N	G	K	N	N	E	Y	E	I	E	A	Y	E	K	C	O	H	L	S
B	B	S	L	N	D	B	E	N	O	L	G	S	N	I	K	Q	A	S	E	E

Name

Address

Telephone

Just send in your correctly completed word search to the address below, along with your name and address, by Tuesday 18th April. The winner's name will be pulled out of a hat. Word Search Competition, FAO Marie Dunster, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH or drop the entry into Gallions reception.

LOCAL Listings

Chemists

Whinchat Chemist
1 Whinchat Road,
Tel: 0208 333 5000

A F Browne Chemist
4 Tavy Bridge
Tel: 0208 310 7209

Churches

Christian Life Centre
11 Arnott Close
Tel: 020 8310 5361

St Paul's Ecumenical Church
Bentham Road,
Tel: 020 8310 6814

Titmuss Avenue Baptist Church
85 Titmuss Avenue
Tel: 020 8310 1683

Power Light Evangelism Ministries
The Village Hall
2 c Goosander Way
Tel 0208 310 9149
powerlightevang@aol.com

Open Gateway United Church
62-64 Battery Road
Tel 0208 836 9069

Dentists

Gallions Reach Dental Anaesthetic Clinic

Heronsgate Dental Centre
1b Gooseander Way
Tel: 020 8316 6313

Vijay Vithani
12 Joyce Dawson Way
Tel: 020 8311 9400

Doctors

Heronsgate Medical Centre
1a Gooseander Way
Tel: 020 8333 5050

Gallions Reach Health Centre
Bentham Road
Tel: 020 8333 5000

Hospitals

Queen Elizabeth Hospital
Stadium Road, Woolwich
Tel: 020 8836 6000

Queen Mary's Hospital
Frognal Avenue, Sidcup
Tel: 020 8302 2678

Transport

National Rail Enquiries
Tel: 08457 484950

London Travel Information
Tel: 020 7222 1234

Festival Fun

This year's Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival is shaping up to be another fantastic family day out. Schools, clubs and groups around Thamesmead are already working on projects to be showcased at the event. Chart topping acts and some of Thamesmead's brightest stars are set to share centre stage. Make sure you keep Saturday 15th July free as Thamesmead once again turns out in force to party.

Correction

The March issue of Thamesview carried a story about the UK Online computer bus which visits Thamesmead. On Thursdays it is parked from 10am to 12.30pm opposite the shops on Whinchat Road. It no longer visits Titmuss Avenue on a Friday. Apologies for any confusion.

For more information please contact Andy Macdonald on 07958 745404.

If undelivered please return to: Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH